

SECTION 1 — IMPORT-READY SOURCE FILE

AP U.S. History Free-Response Practice Exam 9

APUSH-SAQ9-001

Section: SAQ

Type: written

Unit: Unit 8 — Period 8: 1945–1980

Period: Period 8: 1945–1980

Theme: NAT — American and National Identity

Historical Reasoning: Comparison

Source Type: Secondary text source

Prompt:

Source A: Original secondary interpretation written for this practice exam, not an actual quotation. A historian of the early Cold War argues that domestic anti-communism grew primarily from genuine fears about national security. According to this interpretation, Soviet expansion, espionage cases, nuclear competition, and the Korean War convinced many Americans that communist influence at home could weaken the nation.

Source B: Original secondary interpretation written for this practice exam, not an actual quotation. A historian of postwar politics argues that domestic anti-communism also became a tool for policing dissent and defining acceptable American identity. According to this interpretation, accusations of communist sympathy were often used against labor activists, civil rights advocates, artists, federal workers, and political opponents.

- (a) Describe one major difference between the two interpretations of domestic anti-communism.
- (b) Explain one piece of historical evidence that supports the argument in Source A.
- (c) Explain one piece of historical evidence that supports the argument in Source B.

Scoring Guide:

Total Points: 3

- (a) 1 point: Describes a valid difference, such as Source A emphasizing national security fears while Source B emphasizes political repression, conformity, and the use of anti-communism against dissent.
- (b) 1 point: Explains relevant evidence supporting Source A, such as Soviet atomic development, the Korean War, the fall of China to communism, espionage concerns, the Rosenberg case, Alger Hiss, or federal loyalty programs.
- (c) 1 point: Explains relevant evidence supporting Source B, such as HUAC investigations, Hollywood blacklists, McCarthyism, loyalty oaths, attacks on unions, accusations against civil rights activists, or suppression of left-wing political expression.

Model Guidance:

A strong answer should recognize that Cold War anti-communism had both security and political dimensions. It should avoid claiming that all anti-communism was either fully justified or entirely manufactured, and should use specific evidence to support each interpretation.

Expected Points:

3

APUSH-SAQ9-002

Section: SAQ

Type: written

Unit: Unit 2 — Period 2: 1607–1754

Period: Period 2: 1607–1754

Theme: SOC — Social Structures

Historical Reasoning: Sourcing / POV / Purpose / Audience

Source Type: Primary text source

Prompt:

Source: Original simulated source based on historical context, not an actual quotation.

A Massachusetts town resident questioned during a witchcraft investigation, 1692.

“I have quarreled with neighbors over boundary stones, firewood, and the care of children left without fathers. Now old resentments are repeated as signs of the Devil’s work. The ministers warn that Satan attacks the godly, yet I fear that fear itself has given sharp tongues more power than evidence. If a woman is poor, angry, or alone, every misfortune in the village may be placed upon her.”

- (a) Identify one historical development that shaped the situation described in the source.
- (b) Explain how the speaker’s point of view likely influenced the concerns expressed in the source.
- (c) Explain one way the source reflects broader social or religious tensions in colonial New England.

Scoring Guide:

Total Points: 3

- (a) 1 point: Identifies a relevant development, such as the Salem witch trials, Puritan religious culture, fears of disorder in New England towns, King William’s War and frontier anxiety, local property disputes, gender expectations, or communal religious discipline.
- (b) 1 point: Explains that the speaker’s point of view as a town resident caught in local conflict shaped concerns about gossip, evidence, poverty, gender, neighborhood disputes, and the danger of accusations.
- (c) 1 point: Explains a broader tension, such as Puritan fears of sin and Satan, pressure for community conformity, gendered suspicion of women outside household norms, inheritance or property conflicts, anxieties caused by war and instability, or declining confidence in older religious authority.

Model Guidance:

A strong answer should connect witchcraft accusations to broader social, religious, gender, and community tensions. It should avoid treating the Salem crisis as simply superstition and should explain how local conflict and religious worldview interacted.

Expected Points:

3

APUSH-SAQ9-003

Section: SAQ

Type: written

Unit: Unit 7 — Period 7: 1890–1945

Period: Period 7: 1890–1945

Theme: GEO — Geography and the Environment

Historical Reasoning: Causation

Source Type: Non-text source

Prompt:

Source: Described map and data key created for this practice exam.

The map is titled “Drought, Soil Erosion, and Migration in the Great Plains, 1930–1940.” It shows the hardest-hit Dust Bowl counties in the Texas Panhandle, Oklahoma Panhandle, western Kansas, eastern Colorado, and northeastern New Mexico. Arrows point west toward California, Oregon, and Washington. A small data key notes: “Many affected counties experienced crop failures, farm foreclosures, dust storms, and population decline. Federal soil-conservation projects and emergency relief programs expanded during the decade.”

- (a) Describe one environmental or economic problem reflected in the source.
- (b) Explain one cause of the environmental or economic problem described in part (a).
- (c) Explain one consequence of the Dust Bowl for American society or government policy during the 1930s.

Scoring Guide:

Total Points: 3

- (a) 1 point: Describes a valid problem, such as drought, soil erosion, dust storms, crop failure, farm foreclosure, rural poverty, or migration out of the Great Plains.
- (b) 1 point: Explains a relevant cause, such as prolonged drought, overplowing of grasslands, mechanized agriculture, expansion of wheat farming, weak soil conservation practices, falling crop prices, or environmental vulnerability of the southern Plains.
- (c) 1 point: Explains a relevant consequence, such as migration to California and the West Coast, federal relief programs, soil conservation efforts, rural resettlement programs, farm-policy debates, cultural attention to migrant poverty, or expanded expectations of federal responsibility during the Great Depression.

Model Guidance:

A strong answer should connect environmental crisis to human decisions, economic pressures, and federal response. It should avoid treating the Dust Bowl as only a natural disaster and should explain how farming practices, drought, markets, migration, and government policy were connected.

Expected Points:

3

APUSH-DBQ9-001

Section: DBQ

Type: written

Unit: Unit 6 — Period 6: 1865–1898

Period: Period 6: 1865–1898

Theme: PCE — Politics and Power

Historical Reasoning: Causation

Source Type: Seven-document set

Prompt:

Evaluate the extent to which urban political machines shaped city government and residents’ lives in the United States from 1870 to 1900.

Document 1

Author/Origin: Described ward map created for this practice exam, large northeastern city, circa 1885.

Source Type: Described map.

The map shows several crowded working-class wards near docks, factories, rail yards, and tenement districts. Symbols mark ward club offices, firehouses, police stations, public works projects, and polling places. The wards with the most club offices also show high voter turnout and frequent requests for street repairs, coal assistance, and public jobs.

Sourcing Cues: The map emphasizes the local, neighborhood-based structure of machine politics and its connection to services, jobs, and elections.

Document 2

Author/Origin: Original simulated note from a ward captain to a precinct worker, New York City, 1882; based on historical context, not an actual quotation.

Source Type: Political organization note.

“Mrs. Donnelly’s rent trouble should be taken to the alderman before Friday. Send two men to help the Rossi family with coal. Remind the new voters on Baxter Street where to register. A man remembers who helped him when winter came, and he remembers again on election day.”

Sourcing Cues: The note reflects the practical, personal, and transactional nature of ward-level machine politics.

Document 3

Author/Origin: Original simulated statement from a municipal reform association, Philadelphia, 1887; based on historical context, not an actual quotation.

Source Type: Reform statement excerpt.

“Contracts for paving, lighting, and water service are awarded not to the most efficient bidder but to the loyal friend of the organization. Taxpayers pay twice: once in money wasted and again in government degraded. The city must replace partisan favoritism with professional administration.”

Sourcing Cues: The statement reflects middle-class reformers’ criticism of corruption, patronage, and inefficiency.

Document 4

Author/Origin: Original simulated letter from a recently naturalized voter to his brother, Chicago, 1890; based on historical context, not an actual quotation.

Source Type: Primary text source.

“The ward men know every family on the block. They find work for some, translate papers for others, and speak to police when trouble comes. The reform gentlemen say we are bought, but they do not come when a child is sick or a landlord threatens. I vote for those who know my street.”

Sourcing Cues: The letter reflects the viewpoint of an urban working-class voter who values machine services despite reform criticism.

Document 5

Author/Origin: Described political cartoon from a reform newspaper, United States, 1894.

Source Type: Described political cartoon.

The cartoon shows a large figure labeled “The Boss” sitting behind a city council desk. Strings run from his fingers to small figures labeled “alderman,” “contractor,” “police chief,” and “building inspector.” Outside the window, citizens wait in line at a broken water pump while a sign reads “Taxes Paid Here.”

Sourcing Cues: The cartoon reflects reformers’ claim that political bosses controlled public offices and diverted city resources.

Document 6

Author/Origin: Municipal budget table created for this practice exam, selected city departments, 1875–1895.

Source Type: Data table.

The table is titled “Selected Urban Spending Patterns in One Large City.”

Department | 1875 spending trend | 1895 spending trend | Common controversy
Street cleaning | low and irregular | higher but uneven | contracts tied to party allies
Police | expanding | expanded further | political influence over appointments
Public works | growing | much larger | patronage jobs and contract favoritism
Charity relief | informal and limited | more connected to ward networks | aid exchanged for loyalty

A note beneath the table states: “Urban growth increased demand for services, but machine control raised questions about corruption, favoritism, and access.”

Sourcing Cues: The table highlights the relationship among urban growth, public services, patronage, and political controversy.

Document 7

Author/Origin: Original simulated statement from a Black church leader to a city council committee, northern city, 1896; based on historical context, not an actual quotation.

Source Type: Public testimony excerpt.

“Our neighborhood is asked for votes, but our streets receive repairs last. Party men promise protection, yet colored workers are passed over for many city jobs. If ward politics is to speak for the people, then it must speak for all of them, not only for those whose support is easiest to reward.”

Sourcing Cues: The testimony reflects African American urban residents’ criticism of unequal access to machine benefits and municipal services.

Scoring Guide:

Total Points: 7

Thesis / Claim — 1 point: Earns the point for a historically defensible claim evaluating the extent to which urban political machines shaped city government and residents’ lives from 1870 to 1900. The thesis must make an argument, such as that machines strongly shaped urban politics by providing services, jobs, and voter mobilization while also encouraging corruption, unequal access, and reform opposition.

Contextualization — 1 point: Earns the point by describing broader relevant context, such as rapid urbanization, industrialization, immigration, growth of tenements, weak municipal services, patronage politics, expansion of voting, Gilded Age corruption, or middle-class reform movements.

Evidence from the Documents — 2 points: Earns 1 point for accurately using content from at least three documents to address the prompt. Earns 2 points for using content from at least six documents to support a coherent argument about ward organization, social services, voter mobilization, patronage, corruption, municipal spending, reform criticism, or unequal access to machine benefits.

Evidence Beyond the Documents — 1 point: Earns the point for using at least one specific, relevant piece of outside evidence not found in the documents, such as Tammany Hall, Boss Tweed, Thomas Nast, patronage, civil service reform, Pendleton Civil Service Act, tenement districts, settlement houses, municipal reform leagues, or ethnic political clubs.

Sourcing / Analysis of Documents — 1 point: Earns the point by explaining how or why the point of view, purpose, audience, or historical situation of at least three documents is relevant to the argument. For example, a student might analyze the ward captain’s electoral motives, the reform association’s middle-class efficiency concerns, the working-class voter’s dependence on local aid, the cartoon’s reform purpose, the budget table’s link between urban growth and patronage, or the Black church leader’s criticism of unequal access.

Complexity — 1 point: Earns the point by demonstrating a nuanced argument, such as explaining that machines were both corrupt and responsive; distinguishing between middle-class reform views and working-class voter needs; showing that machine benefits were uneven by race, ethnicity,

gender, and neighborhood; or explaining that urban growth created real service needs that machines exploited and partially met.

Model Guidance:

A strong DBQ would likely argue that political machines deeply shaped city government by organizing votes, distributing jobs and aid, influencing police and public works, and controlling contracts. However, the best responses should avoid a one-sided argument. Machines could provide practical assistance to residents ignored by formal institutions, but they also encouraged corruption, favoritism, and unequal access. Useful document groupings include ward-level services, reform criticism, voter loyalty, boss control, public spending, and unequal racial access to city benefits. Relevant outside evidence could include Tammany Hall, Boss Tweed, Thomas Nast, patronage, the Pendleton Civil Service Act, tenement politics, or municipal reform leagues.

Expected Points:

7

APUSH-LEQ9-001

Section: LEQ

Type: written

Unit: Unit 4 — Period 4: 1800–1848

Period: Cross-Period / Thematic

Theme: WXT — Work, Exchange, and Technology

Historical Reasoning: Continuity and Change Over Time

Source Type: Broad historical prompt with introductory statement

Prompt:

From the early republic through the late nineteenth century, transportation and communication networks changed the ways Americans exchanged goods, information, people, and political ideas. Roads, canals, steamboats, railroads, the postal system, telegraph lines, and later transcontinental connections linked some regions more closely while also intensifying conflicts over land, labor, markets, and regional power.

Evaluate the extent to which transportation and communication networks changed economic and political integration in the United States from 1783 to 1898.

Scoring Guide:

Total Points: 6

Thesis / Claim — 1 point: Earns the point for a historically defensible thesis that evaluates the extent to which transportation and communication networks changed economic and political integration from 1783 to 1898. The thesis must make an argument about continuity, change, or both.

Contextualization — 1 point: Earns the point by describing broader context relevant to transportation and communication, such as post-Revolutionary western settlement, federal land policy, market growth, regional specialization, industrialization, expansion of newspapers, slavery's expansion, sectionalism, railroad development, or national markets.

Evidence — 2 points: Earns 1 point for identifying at least two specific pieces of relevant evidence, such as the National Road, Erie Canal, steamboats, canals, turnpikes, postal networks, railroads, telegraph, transportation of cotton and manufactured goods, Pacific Railway Act, transcontinental railroad, railroad time zones, or railroad corporations. Earns 2 points for using at least two pieces of evidence to support an argument about economic and political integration.

Historical Reasoning — 1 point: Earns the point by explaining continuity and change over time, such as showing how networks increasingly integrated regional markets, sped communication, supported migration and state-building, and strengthened national connections, while also reinforcing sectional specialization, land conflict, corporate power, and uneven regional

development.

Complexity — 1 point: Earns the point by developing a nuanced argument, such as explaining that transportation and communication integrated the nation economically while sometimes deepening political conflict; comparing canals and railroads; distinguishing regional effects; or showing how networks connected markets and people while also expanding slavery, displacing Native nations, and increasing corporate influence.

Model Guidance:

A strong LEQ should explain how networks changed integration rather than simply list inventions. It might argue that canals, steamboats, railroads, postal routes, and telegraphs linked regional economies and sped political communication, but did not produce simple national unity. Strong responses should recognize uneven effects: transportation helped integrate markets, encourage migration, and expand federal and corporate power, while also deepening sectional tensions, land conflicts, and regional inequalities.

Expected Points:

6

SECTION 2 — SERIES DO-NOT-REPEAT BANK UPDATE — DO NOT IMPORT

SERIES DO-NOT-REPEAT BANK UPDATE — APUSH-FRQ9

· APUSH-SAQ9-001: Unit 8; Period 8: 1945–1980; perspectives include modern secondary historians of domestic anti-communism as national security response and as political/cultural repression; source type is paired secondary text interpretations; source viewpoints contrast genuine Cold War security fears with policing of dissent and acceptable American identity; historical development is domestic anti-communism, loyalty programs, HUAC, McCarthyism, and civil-liberty debates; reasoning path is comparison; misconception targeted is treating anti-communism as either entirely justified national defense or entirely invented political repression without recognizing both contexts.

· APUSH-SAQ9-002: Unit 2; Period 2: 1607–1754; perspective is Massachusetts town resident questioned during witchcraft investigation in 1692; source type is original simulated primary text; source viewpoint emphasizes neighborhood conflict, gendered suspicion, property disputes, religious fear, evidence, poverty, and social marginality; historical development is Salem witch trials and Puritan social/religious tensions in colonial New England; reasoning path is POV/purpose/audience connected to communal discipline, gender, fear, and local conflict; misconception targeted is treating Salem only as irrational superstition rather than a crisis rooted in religious worldview, gender, war anxiety, property conflict, and community pressure.

· APUSH-SAQ9-003: Unit 7; Period 7: 1890–1945; perspectives include Great Plains farmers, migrant families, federal relief officials, soil conservation workers, western receiving communities, and agricultural markets; non-text source type is described Dust Bowl map with data key; visual/data/map pattern is drought/erosion counties, migration arrows to the West Coast, crop failures, farm foreclosures, population decline, and federal soil-conservation/relief response; historical development is Dust Bowl environmental crisis, rural poverty, migration, and New Deal-era conservation/relief responses; reasoning path is causation linking drought, farming practices, economic depression, migration, and federal policy; misconception targeted is treating the Dust Bowl as only a natural disaster without human land use, economic pressure, migration, and policy consequences.

· APUSH-DBQ9-001: Unit 6; Period 6: 1865–1898; DBQ topic is urban political machines shaping city government and residents' lives from 1870 to 1900; document types include described ward

map, ward captain note, municipal reform association statement, naturalized voter letter, described political cartoon, municipal budget table, and Black church leader public testimony; document perspectives include ward captains, working-class urban voters, municipal reformers, contractors, police/public works officials, taxpayers, African American residents, party organizations, and city service recipients; main argument paths include neighborhood-based political organization, patronage, social assistance, voter mobilization, corruption, contract favoritism, public services, reform opposition, and unequal racial/ethnic access to benefits; outside evidence possibilities include Tammany Hall, Boss Tweed, Thomas Nast, patronage, civil service reform, Pendleton Civil Service Act, tenement districts, settlement houses, municipal reform leagues, and ethnic political clubs; sourcing opportunities include ward captain electoral motive, reform association middle-class efficiency purpose, naturalized voter's service-based loyalty, cartoon's anti-boss reform perspective, budget table's urban-service context, and Black church leader's critique of unequal municipal benefits; visual/data/map types include described ward-service map, reform political cartoon, and municipal spending data table.

· APUSH-LEQ9-001: Units 3–6; Periods 3–6 / Cross-Period; LEQ topic is transportation and communication networks changing economic and political integration from 1783 to 1898; historical reasoning process is continuity and change over time; evidence categories include National Road, Erie Canal, canals, steamboats, turnpikes, postal networks, newspapers, railroads, telegraph, regional commodity flows, Pacific Railway Act, transcontinental railroad, railroad corporations, railroad time zones, migration, and market integration; complexity path is explaining that networks integrated markets and communication while also deepening sectional specialization, land conflict, slavery expansion, corporate power, and uneven regional development; misconception targeted is treating transportation and communication improvements as simple national progress without political conflict, regional inequality, or coercive expansion.